Xiangdong (Easton) Hu

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Computer Science Ph.D. student researching trustworthy AI, with interests in multimodal model security, speech privacy, and foundation-model evaluation.

EDUCATION

University of Georgia May 2026 - Present
Ph.D. in Computer Science | Advisor: Dr. Jian Liu

Georgia State University Jan 2025 - May 2026
M.S. in Computer Science | Advisor: Dr. Qin Hu | GPA: **4.00/4.00**

NingboTech University Sep 2020 - Jun 2024
B.Eng. in Computer Science | Qiushi Class, joint program with Zhejiang University

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

University of Georgia, MOSIS Lab May 2026 - Present
Research Assistant | Advisor: Dr. Jian Liu

- Led the development of **VoiceShield**, to our knowledge the first voice-protection model to support streaming audio input and output with ultra-low latency.
- Deployed VoiceShield on Mac, iPhone, and NVIDIA Jetson with switchable offline and streaming inference.
- Achieved state-of-the-art offline protection and top perceptual-quality ratings among evaluated baselines.

Georgia State University, INSPIRE Lab Jun 2025 - May 2026
Graduate Researcher | Advisor: Dr. Qin Hu

- Conceived and led **GAMBIT (ACL 2026 Oral)** from research idea through implementation and evaluation, combining puzzle-based visual encoding and gamified prompts to study multimodal model safety.
- Achieved attack success rates of 92.13% on Gemini 2.5 Flash and 85.87% on GPT-4o; examined how task complexity affects safety behavior in reasoning and non-reasoning models.
- Studied straggler-tolerant hierarchical federated learning using Raft-based blockchain coordination and HieAvg aggregation; analyzed convergence and latency under non-IID data.
- Evaluated federated-learning performance on Raspberry Pi and AWS EC2 testbeds, examining the trade-off between consensus delay and global model convergence.

Zhejiang Lab, Artificial Intelligence Research Institute Sep 2023 - Dec 2023
Research Assistant Intern

- Contributed to **NOVA-3D**, a framework for reconstructing full-body 3D anime characters from non-overlapping front and back images, enabling consistent rendering from new viewpoints.
- Helped implement direction-aware attention for view fusion and processed 3D assets into rendered training data to improve cross-view consistency.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Georgia State University | Graduate Teaching Assistant Jan 2025 - Apr 2026

- Supported CSC 6330 (Programming Language Concepts) and CSC 8230 (Secure and Private AI), with approximately 40 students per class; graded coursework and created problem sets and code examples.

Georgia State University | Lab Instructor Jan 2026 - Apr 2026

- Independently taught three CSC 1302L (Principles of Computer Science II) lab sections serving approximately 75 students; led weekly Python and data-structures instruction, coding exercises, and debugging practice.

PUBLICATIONS AND MANUSCRIPTS

Peer-reviewed Publication

GAMBIT: A Gamified Jailbreak Framework for Multimodal Large Language Models
Xiangdong Hu, Yangyang Jiang, Qin Hu, Xiaojun Jia.
ACL 2026 | Oral presentation, San Diego. | Paper

Manuscripts

VoiceShield: Practical and Perceptually Transparent Real-Time Voice Protection against AI Cloning
Xiangdong Hu, Yi Chen Liu, Jian Liu.
Under review at **USENIX Security 2027**.

EMG-FoundBench: A Systematic Benchmark of Foundation Model Transfer and Adaptation for Electromyography
Tianhao Wu, Jiawei Yu, **Xiangdong Hu**, Xu Wu, Hongyu Wu, Sidharth Anupkrishnan, Amirmohammad Radmehr, Yi Chen Liu, Phuc Nguyen, Yi Wu, Jian Liu.
Under review at **ICLR 2027**.
Benchmark of nine model configurations across 20 public datasets and 200,000+ EMG segments, covering representation reuse, fine-tuning, cross-user transfer, and few-shot calibration.

Straggler Mitigation and Latency Optimization in Blockchain-based Hierarchical Federated Learning
Zhilin Wang, **Xiangdong Hu**, Qin Hu, Minghui Xu, Zehui Xiong.
Under review at **IEEE Internet of Things Journal**.

NOVA-3D: Non-overlapped Views for 3D Anime Character Reconstruction
Hongsheng Wang, Jiachen Liu, Huahao Xu, Haoyang Huang, Xinyi Zhou, Linwei Dai, **Xiangdong Hu**, Xiaomei Zhang, Xiangyu Zhu, Shengyu Zhang, Linlin Shen, Fei Wu, Feng Lin.
Manuscript, 2023.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Reviewer: NeurIPS, ACL, ACM CCS, IEEE INFOCOM, USENIX Security.

SELECTED HONORS AND AWARDS

Three Regional Bronze Medals, International Collegiate Programming Contest (ICPC), 2022.
Bronze Medal, China Collegiate Programming Contest (CCPC), Weihai, 2022.
Bronze Medals, Zhejiang Provincial Collegiate Programming Contest (2022, 2023).
Team Silver (2023) and Team Bronze (2022), China Group Programming Ladder Tournament.
Graduation Honorary Certificate, Zhejiang University (2024).

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Languages: Python, C/C++, Java, SQL, R.
Frameworks and Libraries: PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers, OpenCV, Core ML.
Tools and Platforms: Linux/Bash, Git, Docker, AWS EC2, CUDA, MySQL, LaTeX.